

Colour Profiles

You may have bought a new monitor, but are aware you need to assign the right colour profile to it? The purpose of colour profiling your computer is to reproduce accurate colours from one device to another, by mapping each device's colour gamut. When done correctly, this means that the photo you scanned will be displayed as accurately as possible by your monitor, and printed just as accurately by your printer. This process will never be perfect, as each device has certain inherent limitations on its level.

You have a system RGB colour profile, such as Adobe 1998 RGB. This is the basis of all the other colour management on your computer; all other devices look to this to display proper colour. Your monitor should have a profile created by the manufacturer. The same applies for your scanner, printer and any other device that uses colour. Any file you open will be checked to see if it has a colour profile attached, and whether it should convert the colour to your profile,

keep the old one, or assign one to it, incase it does not have one.

Monitors should be set manually, using your eyes as the best judge and not the monitor profile. This is because every user has different preferences, and the room lighting will also affect the display. You can calibrate your monitor to your eyes by using Adobe gamma, a utility that comes with your monitor, or programs such as Colorific. However, if you are not the only one using your computer, this may be a problem. In which case you can save multiple profiles and re-use them accordingly.

Since monitors are easily adjustable, they are also wrong most of the time. You may have increased brightness for a game, or a power outage may reset your settings, in which case the display will be radically different to what your printer prints. Monitors also succumb to age, the electron guns age at different rates and affect the colour balance.

results when generating parallel lines patterns in the Distortion tests.

Another impressive performer was LG Studioworks 700S, which showed very little image distortion and stood third only because of some variation in the dimensions during the screen regulation tests.

BenQ V991 and LG Studioworks 900B, both topped this test in the 19-inches category, by logging a score of 26.75. Thus, they are ideal for graphic and Web designers who have to deal with lot of vector diagrams and animations. Samsung Syncmaster 955DF stood second with score of 16.5 points.

NEC MultiSync 95 was the worst performer with a score of only 16 points—this was due to the poor performance in all the regulation tests. With respect to the price criteria, NEC MultiSync 95 was the lowest costing Rs 17,000. However, its performance was not acceptable, and definitely not recommended for professionals.

For the sharpness tests, Samsung SyncMaster 763MB came first, scoring 22.5 points, as it performed exceptionally well in most subtests, except for a few such as the horizontal bar resolution test. On the other hand, Compaq MV 7500 scored 21.75 points. Hence, people who need high resolution to work with 2D or 3D engineering drawing, should opt for the Samsung SyncMaster 763MB. The monitor which finished at the bottom in this test was the NEC MultiSync 75 that suffered in all seven sub-tests, taking a maximum beating in the horizontal bar resolution test.

In the 19-inch category, BenQ V991 emerged as the winner, scoring 23.25 points. It performed well in all the tests, although it did take a beating in the diagonal resolution and fine resolution matrix test. NEC Multi Sync 95 and Samsung Syncmaster 955DF were poor performers, and came last due to their average performance in all the resolution tests.

CD, drivers CD, etc. and does not provide any additional multimedia features.

Performance

The Geometry test was the main evaluator of the the monitor's capabilities. Displaymates' internal pincushion and Barrel distortion test is done to rate the accuracy of the geometrical shapes produced. The screen doesn't wrap the raster from corner to corner, and hence the screen corners are cut or show the black background. This can be irritating when working with applications such as image editors. This test helped wrap the screen to the raster perfectly, to eliminate the geometry distortion and provide the maximum screen area. In the 17-inch category, Microtek 43F1 and LG E700S disappointed us by yielding below average

results in four image regulation tests—except for the Pincushion and Barrel distortion test—and the variation in the size and shape of the test images was drastic. These monitors tend to show a variation in screen size while toggling between two Word documents or Excel sheets.

The Compaq MV7500 shone in the Geometry tests for the 17-inch category. It had an impressive overall screen geometry score of 22.5. This was 2 points ahead of its nearest rival, the Samsung SyncMaster 753DFX that scored 20.5 points. This performance was largely due to the impressive scores in the regulation test, where there was hardly any changes in the size and shape, and no perceptible clipping of the screen when brightness levels were suddenly increased. Surprisingly, the monitor gave only average



LG Studioworks 700S
+ Overall good performance; light weight
- Flimsy construction



Microtek Flatvision 43F1
+ Good looking
- Average overall performance; no antiglare coating



NEC Multisync 75
+ Good refresh rate
- Bulky; Semi-tint coating



Samsung Syncmaster 753DFX
+ F&FST; good performance overall
- NA



Samsung Syncmaster 763MB
+ F&FST, Magic Bright feature
- A tad expensive